

YILAN ANNIE GAO

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Bilingual English & Mandarin

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

- **12 years of program leadership** driving complex, cross-functional product innovation and operations in fast-paced global technology environments.
- **Specialized in Product Innovation:** Holder of a Master of Product Innovation (M.P.I.) with a proven track record of transforming ambiguous business challenges into structured product frameworks and scalable operational systems.
- **End-to-End Lifecycle Ownership:** Expert at maintaining master project calendars, managing work-back schedules, and aligning Engineering, Policy, Legal, and Finance teams toward high-stakes GTM milestones.
- **Executive Strategic Partner:** Experienced in supporting VP and C-suite decision-making through **strategic data operations**, executive reporting frameworks, and clear strategic narratives.
- **Global Scaling Expert:** Deep multi-regional experience spanning the US, China, Japan, and LATAM, with full bilingual fluency in English and Mandarin.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

SENIOR PROGRAM MANAGER, Product Operations & Developer Relations

Roblox | San Mateo, CA | Feb 2023 – Present

Product Innovation & Cross-Functional GTM (2025–Present)

- **Primary POC for Top Creator Accounts:** Lead alignment across Engineering, Policy, Legal, and Moderation to drive shared goals, timelines, and deliverables for the platform's most valuable partners.
- **Product Lifecycle Development:** Built Roblox's first false-moderation protection system from zero—defining the technical process, escalation workflows, and communication strategy to improve platform reliability.
- **IP Protection GTM Strategy:** Orchestrated the end-to-end rollout of a new IP protection product; onboarded top 15 developer teams through phased launch management and continuous feedback loops.
- **Resource Planning:** Manage 3 direct reports; transformed support ticket trends into actionable insights that informed product resource allocation and process improvements.

LiveOps – Event Production & Project Management (2024)

- **Global Event Execution:** Project-managed 5 platform-wide live events (10M+ players each), overseeing the full lifecycle from planning through live execution while managing high-velocity vendor risks.
- **Strategic Reporting:** Translated real-time and post-event analytics into executive-level recommendations, shaping the roadmap for subsequent platform-wide engagement strategies.

International Expansion & Operations (2023)

- **Ecosystem Innovation:** Co-designed a structured developer feedback system that embedded global insights (China, Japan, LATAM) into the core product development cycle upstream.

SENIOR PROGRAM MANAGER, Product Operations & Developer Relations

Roblox China | Shenzhen, China | Mar 2021 – Feb 2023

- **Data Analysis Strategy: Pioneered the data analysis strategy** for the DevRel team, establishing key performance indicators (KPIs) and reporting structures that bridged local market trends with global business objectives.
- **GTM Strategy & Launch:** Defined the GTM strategy for the Roblox China platform launch; built the executive reporting framework to track post-launch performance and identify emerging risks.
- **China-US Integration:** Acted as the primary strategic link between China market priorities and Global HQ product roadmaps; negotiated data access frameworks with US Finance and Legal teams.
- **Requirements Prioritization:** Structured ambiguous local compliance and regulatory needs into prioritized technical requirements for global engineering teams.

PARTNERSHIP PROGRAM LEAD

California State University | San Bernardino, CA | Apr 2019 – Apr 2021

- **Portfolio Management:** Managed a \$4M+ institutional partnership portfolio, achieving 60% recruitment growth and a 100% program renewal rate through process optimization.

CHINA PROGRAM MANAGER

Virginia Commonwealth University Richmond, VA | Jul 2014 – Mar 2019

- **Strategic Growth:** Led international entry strategy achieving 300% enrollment growth; coordinated relationships across 10+ departments and 20+ partner institutions.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

- **Master of Product Innovation (M.P.I.)**
– Virginia Commonwealth University | 2018
- **Master of Education (M.Ed.) – Adult Learning & HRD**
– Virginia Commonwealth University | 2014
- **Bachelor of Arts – English & International Relations**
– Sichuan International Studies University | 2018
- **Certifications:** PMP (Project Management Professional), CSM (Certified Scrum Master)

SKILLS & TOOLS

- **Methodologies:** Product Lifecycle Management (PLM), Data Analysis Strategy, Agile, Scrum, Kanban, GTM Strategy, Risk Mitigation.
- **Technical:** Excel, Jira, Confluence, Data Visualization, AI-driven Workflow Automation.
- **Languages:** English, Mandarin Chinese